

News Weekly

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Fifa reveals 2026 World Cup match locations

The 2026 World Cup, the most viewed sporting event globally, will take place in Canada, Mexico, and the United States. Fans learned about match locations and expected temperatures, highlighting diverse venues from Toronto and Vancouver to Mexico City and Los Angeles. The tournament will feature varying climates, with cooler northern venues and warm southern locations, testing players' adaptability. Additionally, fans can enjoy North America's rich culture through local cuisine, landmarks, and arts. Anticipation builds for an unforgettable event that unites global fans in their love for soccer.



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New school loan limits may reduce the pipeline of physicians and nurses, educators caution

A little-noticed provision in the sweeping "One Big Beautiful" legislation enacted by the GOP over the summer sharply limits the amount of federal student loans that students earning professional degrees — including medical school — can borrow. It also imposes even stricter borrowing caps for other health fields including nursing and public health. The Education Department does not consider graduate education in those fields "professional" education, though officials described that as a technical and regulatory decision, rather than a value judgment. The loan changes will hit next July when an open-ended federal loan program known as Grad PLUS will stop making new loans. From that point on, med students won't be able to borrow more than \$50,000 a year — or more than \$200,000 over the four years. Many private med schools already cost north of \$300,000, including living expenses.



CDC advisers delay vote on major change to the childhood vaccine schedule until Friday

Vaccine advisers to the U.S. Centers for Disease Control and Prevention have just concluded the first day of a two-day meeting that may result in significant changes to the childhood vaccination schedule.

- *A planned vote regarding potential alterations to the hepatitis B vaccination for newborns has been postponed until Friday morning.*
- *On Friday, the focus will shift to discussing the ingredients and timing of vaccines included in the childhood schedule.*

The committee members were carefully selected by U.S. Health and Human Services Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr., a well-known anti-vaccine advocate, after he unexpectedly dismissed the 17 sitting members earlier this year.



Video shows wild wolf appearing to use a tool to steal fish

A new study documented wild wolves using ropes to pull crab traps ashore, offering what may be the first proof of tool use by these animals. According to the study, the female wolf appeared to understand “the multi-step connection between the floating buoy and the bait within the out-of-sight trap.” This remarkable behavior suggests a higher level of cognitive ability and problem-solving skills than previously attributed to wolves. Observers noted that the wolf watched the buoy intently, then methodically pulled on the rope, eventually retrieving the trap with its prize. This discovery challenges our understanding of animal intelligence and could lead to further research on the cognitive capabilities of other wild species. Such insights are invaluable, as they deepen our appreciation for the complex behaviors exhibited by wildlife and underscore the importance of conserving their natural habitats.



New technology helps paralyzed patients move

Scientists at Northwell Health have developed neural implants enabling patients with paralysis to move limbs through a brain-computer interface, reconnecting the brain, body, and spinal cord. This advancement in neuroprosthetics offers hope and independence to individuals with physical limitations. The implants translate brain signals into movement commands, bypassing damaged nervous system areas. Early trial participants reported improved quality of life and restored mobility, enhancing the mind-body connection. Ongoing research aims to expand the technology's applications for various neurological conditions, with the goal of making it accessible to the patients who need it.



WIN A GIFT FOR THE SEASON!!!

If you're lucky you might score a nifty little top as a bonus with your newspaper this season!



White Hot Chocolate

Ingredients:

- 4 cups of 2% or whole milk
 - 1 tsp. pure vanilla extract
 - 1/4 tsp. kosher salt
 - 4 (4-oz.) white chocolate bars (3 chopped, 1 in large pieces)
 - 3/4 cup heavy cream
 - 1/2 cup mini marshmallows
 - Crushed peppermint candies (optional for serving)
1. In a saucepan, simmer milk, vanilla, and salt, then add chopped chocolate until melted and smooth.
 2. In a bowl, beat cream with an electric mixer until stiff peaks form. Serve white hot chocolate in mugs, topped with whipped cream, marshmallows, peppermint, and broken chocolate pieces.



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